



## MONTHLY UPDATE

# Cote d'Ivoire: monthly update, July 2026

Edition of 2026-08-17 · 53 systems and instruments tracked, 10 of them not held

*Developments recorded from artefacts published between 2026-07-01 and 2026-08-17 — July 2026 carried forward to the date of issue, so the report holds the nightly catch to the day it was cut. Sections follow the status report.*

## Summary of the month

July brought the trust layer and the market layer within eight days of each other. The cyber agency [commissioned the national public key infrastructure](#), announced on 23 July, and a low-orbit satellite operator [went on sale by 17 July](#) on a twelve-month provisional licence. The data-protection compliance platform went live on 2 July, all 39 first-instance tribunals were connected on 29 June, and the United States announced [formal authorisation of a US\\$170m data-centre and border-surveillance package](#) on 16 July.

## Infrastructure

### Connectivity

A low-orbit satellite operator [went live by 17 July](#) at XOF 28,746 a month for residential service, with hardware from XOF 148,148, on a twelve-month provisional licence reviewable on service quality. On 31 July the minister said regional satellite capacity would be routed through the universal-service bodies, with a working session on terms due the following week; no terms, tariff or timetable was stated. No 5G launch occurred against the announced July 2026 date. Ministry figures given on 13 July put telecommunications penetration above 130% of population and [about 38,000 km of optical fibre](#).

On protecting what is already laid, an operator and its vendor [completed a proof of concept in Abidjan that detects vibrations around fibre ducts and classifies them to flag third-party excavation before a cut happens](#), on trials run since 2025. The account is vendor-issued and states no commercial deployment, coverage or date.

### Data Storage

The national data centre was [formally authorised at US\\$170m of United States export-credit financing, its scope now a sovereign data centre, a government digitisation platform and a smart-border surveillance system](#) — up from the US\$66m approved in August 2025, with no site, capacity or completion date stated. The operating commercial facility at Grand-Bassam is unchanged at a design capacity of about 400 racks and 1.5 MW, while its [group committed capital rose to US\\$380m and contracted power across a six-country footprint ran six times higher in the first half of 2026 than a year earlier](#) — group figures, not Ivorian ones.

## Cybersecurity

The cyber agency [commissioned the national public key infrastructure](#) on an announcement dated 23 July 2026, on the legal basis of the 2013 electronic-transactions law and its 2014 and 2016 decrees. It is the trust anchor for every certification authority operating on Ivorian territory; the agency's own notice is not held, so the technical commissioning date is unestablished.

## Digital public infrastructure

### Data Exchange

The minister told an information-systems seminar on 21 and 22 July that the first services onto the interoperability platform [had been chosen largely by volunteering rather than against user priorities](#), against targets of 100 services online by end-2026 and 700 within three years. No count of services in production has been published. Fourteen migration bodies met on 30 July to [co-design a single collection and profiling tool for returning migrants](#) and a roadmap for transferring their data into one directorate; no legal basis, data-protection safeguard or timetable for pooling personal data across fourteen bodies is stated.

### Digital Identity and CRVS

The identification office's director general [put national identification number holders at roughly 11 million](#) on 30 July and named historic duplicate identities inside the register — the disclosure, not the register, is what is new. The office trained sub-prefects on civil registration on 30 and 31 July, after registrars earlier that week.

### Digital Payments and Fintech

A private schools federation signed a convention on 21 July putting fee collection onto mobile money in a 200-school pilot from August. The flat FCFA 100 agency fee levied on every mobile-money counter transaction since November 2025 was [documented on 24 July](#) as authorised by no operator tariff and no regulator, regressive by construction on small transfers.

### Registries (population, land, address, etc.)

Civil-registry software is [installed with hardware in every municipal and sub-prefecture civil-status centre for digital recording of births, marriages and deaths, financed by the European Union](#). Supervision is assigned to sub-prefects rather than to registrars, and the reform is framed as anti-fraud rather than as access.

### Other GovTech and e-Gov

All 39 first-instance tribunals were [connected to the justice platform on 29 June 2026](#), completing an arc that began with a two-court pilot in January 2025; nationality certificates and criminal-record extracts are now issued digitally nationwide. The account describes this as completing phase one, with no phase-two scope or date. The regulator's compliance platform [went live on 2 July 2026](#), slipping from a 25 June date, replacing about a hundred physical files a month with online submission, real-time tracking and traceability for conformity, processing authorisations and video-surveillance authorisations. It was built over two years and piloted by the identification office and the treasury.

## Governance and regulation

### Legislation and regulation

The cyber-security agency is [operating a national security operations centre, a public-administration security-officer network, the national public key infrastructure and auditor certification against the state reference framework](#), resting on the 2013 electronic transactions law whose 2014 and 2016 implementing decrees are the stated legal basis for that infrastructure — the only Ivorian digital statute the base can name implementing decrees for. Against that, [no Ivorian artificial-intelligence statute is published](#): governance runs entirely through non-binding strategy instruments, with the draft cybersecurity strategy the only binding-track vehicle extending state scope to it.

### Strategies, plans and policies

The draft cyber-security strategy for 2026 to 2030 was [put to stakeholder review on 23 July](#) and awaits the Council of Ministers; the 2021 to 2025 text remains the instrument formally in force. The draft extends scope to artificial intelligence, emerging technologies and cloud.

The universal-service agency published its own five-year plan on 11 August. It [rests on four pillars — universal connectivity, digital services and financial inclusion, digital usage and literacy, and operational excellence — across ten projects, four of them funded at FCFA 60.144bn through the national development plan and six from the agency's own funds](#). The stated targets are 300 newly connected localities, smartphone penetration of 80% by 2028 against 40% now, and more than 15,000 km of new fibre by 2028, against a starting point at which 70% of rural households have no internet access. No adoption instrument is published; the plan is the agency's own.

### Standards

On 29 July the agency [set a target of 1,200 certified cyber-security specialists in three years](#), with 88 auditors certified that day.

### Data protection

The mobile-money agents' union [wrote to the regulator on 24 July](#) with four questions on whether kiosk agents may demand, photograph or retain customer identity documents, after four operators required retention. No regulator response is on file.

### Public debate and participation in policymaking

A consumer federation [launched a complaints platform on 30 July](#) charging FCFA 150 per report, with eight stages from filing through mediation to published reports.

## Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

### AI

Six francophone West African states adopted common artificial-intelligence governance guidelines announced on 6 July, non-binding and complementary to national strategies, submitted as a written contribution to a United Nations dialogue. The minister addressed that dialogue in Geneva on 6 and 7 July and proposed a regional African school of artificial intelligence.

### ICT Industry

An electric ride-hailing fleet took delivery of 100 vehicles on 18 July.

### Innovation ecosystem

The ministry [launched two accelerator cohorts and a state procurement platform on 29 July](#), fifteen startups and fifteen digital small firms each accompanied for 24 months, applications closing 13 September, against a target of FCFA 5 to 10bn mobilised from banks, funds and donors.

### US / hyperscaler activities

The United States announced on 16 July that a contractor had received [formal Ivorian authorisation for a US\\$170m export-credit-financed project](#) covering a sovereign national data centre, a government digitisation platform and a smart-border surveillance system, up from US\$66m approved in August 2025. The announcement was made by the United States rather than by any Ivorian instrument.

## Inclusion and capacity

### Access to services

A guarantee arrangement was the month's only committed money in this section. Two conventions signed on 23 July mobilise [up to FCFA 17bn across two windows](#) for small and medium enterprises, with stated attention to women's entrepreneurship; it is an envelope rather than a committed sum.

### Literacy

The national education digitalisation project stands at [six of eight components complete with the technical and financial agreement still unsigned](#). No cost, financier or component list is published: the project is described only by its stage count.

### Training and skills

The civil-service digital-skills programme [closed its thirteenth edition on 29 July](#), training 192 officials from about thirty public bodies over 40 days, against a cumulative claim of more than 37,500 civil servants funded from the ministry's own budget line.

Outside the service, a German-funded accelerator closed a three-month cohort on 4 August, [closing with 51 artificial-intelligence projects across finance, health, law, education and cybersecurity](#). The project count is the only measure published: participant numbers, cost and what becomes of the projects after the demonstration day are not stated, and a project shown at one is not a deployed system.

## Research institutions

The cyber agency and a technology school validated curricula for two cyber-security master's degrees on 28 July, with enrolment stated for the September 2026 academic year and no intake size or funding published.

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